

Seminar dates and topics		
Date	Topics	Required reading
12 February 2025 Room XXX	• Introduction and expectations • Foundations of CSS • Getting started in R	Lazer, D., & Radford, J. (2017). Data ex Machina: Introduction to Big Data. <i>Annual Review of Sociology</i> , 43(1), 19–39. ↗
26 February 2025	• Research ethics in CSS • Social media, web data and web scraping • APIs and web data collection • Data visualization	Fiesler, C., & Proferes, N. (2018). 'Participant' Perceptions of Twitter Research Ethics. <i>Social Media + Society</i>, 4(1). ↗ Freelon, D. (2018). Computational Research in the Post-API Age. <i>Political Communication</i>, 35(4), 665–668. ↗
12 March 2025	• Platform-centered and user-centered data collections • Linked surveys and DBD • Web tracking data	Tromble, R. (2021). Where Have All the Data Gone? A Critical Reflection on Academic Digital Research in the Post-API Age. <i>Social Media + Society</i>, 7(1). ↗ Silber, H., et al. Linking Surveys and Digital Trace Data: Insights From two Studies on Determinants of Data Sharing Behaviour. <i>Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series A: Statistics in Society</i>, 185(S2), S387–S407. ↗
26 March 2025	• Introduction to automated text analysis • Dictionary-based analysis • Validation of model results	Schwemmer, C., & Wieczorek, O. (2020). The Methodological Divide of Sociology: Evidence from Two Decades of Journal Publications. <i>Sociology</i>, 54(1), 3–21. ↗ Bonikowski, B., Luo, Y., & Stuhler, O. (2022). Politics as Usual? Measuring Populism, Nationalism, and Authoritarianism in U.S. Presidential Campaigns (1952–2020) with Neural Language Models. <i>Sociological Methods & Research</i>, 51(4), 1721–1787. ↗
9 April 2025	• Machine learning • Supervised and unsupervised models • Large Language Models	Gilardi, F., Alizadeh, M., & Kubli, M. (2023). ChatGPT outperforms crowd workers for text-annotation tasks. <i>PNAS</i>, 120(30). ↗ Reiss, M. V. (2023). Testing the Reliability of ChatGPT for Text Annotation and Classification: A Cautionary Remark. <i>arXiv Preprint</i>. ↗
30 April 2025	• Open science and reproducibility in CSS • Writing reproducible research papers in R • Presentations of thesis ideas (1st round)	Chan, C.-Hong, Schatto-Eckrodt, T., & Gruber, J. (2024). What makes computational communication science (ir)reproducible? <i>Computational Communication Research</i>, 6(1). ↗ Sen, I., Flöck, F., Weller, K., Weiß, B., & Wagner, C. (2021). A Total Error Framework for Digital Traces of Human Behavior on Online Platforms. <i>Public Opinion Quarterly</i>, 85(S1), 399–422. ↗
14 May 2025	• Presentations of thesis ideas (2nd round) • Coding: troubleshooting	Bauer, P. C., & Landesvatter, C. (2023). Writing a reproducible paper with RStudio and Quarto. <i>OSF Preprint</i> . ↗